vMix Lottery Title Data

Automatic date and next draw ID for every game title

Date	Mon. 9th Sept. 2026
DRAW_ID	Draw ID: 10452 (2 spaces before and after "Draw ID:")

Covers: Pick 3, Play Way and Cash 4 (Morning, Midday, Afternoon, Night) and Lotto. Super 6 is not included.

Contents

1. How it works

2. What you need

3. Install Python

4. Copy the files to the vMix PC

5. First test run

6. Tell the script where to find draw numbers

7. Prepare the title in vMix

8. Connect each preset to its data file (Data Source)

9. Optional: direct push through the vMix Web API

10. Start automatically with Windows

11. Name and file the recordings

12. When a draw is moved or cancelled

13. Daily checklist

14. Changing things later

15. Troubleshooting

Appendix: game keys

1. How it works

vMix cannot write ordinal dates such as "9th" or "12th", and it cannot look up a draw number and add one to it. A small program, **vmix_lotto_data.py**, runs on the vMix computer and does this for you every 5 minutes.

1. It formats today's date from the PC clock, e.g. **Mon. 9th Sept. 2026**.
2. For every game and time period it finds the **last** draw number - from the email blast results database in Supabase, the NLA website, or a manual override - and adds 1.
3. It writes one small file per game into the **output** folder, e.g. `output\pick3_morning.csv`.
4. Each vMix preset reads its own file through a vMix **Data Source** and shows the two values in the title.
5. Optionally it also types the values straight into the title of whichever preset is open, using the vMix Web API.

Where the draw number comes from (tried in this order, for each game):

Order	Source	Notes
1	Manual override	overrides.json. Only used on the date written in it.
2	Supabase	daily_results and lotto_results in your email blast database.
3	Website	about.nla.gd today. The address is one line in config.json.
4	Last good value	Kept in state.json if everything above fails.

> **Tip:** Because the program runs every 5 minutes, as soon as a draw result is published the next draw ID for that game goes up by itself. Nobody has to type it in.

2. What you need

- The vMix computer (Windows 10 or 11) with vMix installed. Data Sources work in all vMix editions that support titles; the optional VB.NET script needs vMix 4K or Pro.
- Internet access on the vMix PC (for Supabase and the website).
- Access to the Supabase project that holds the email blast results (to copy its Project URL and API key).
- Python 3 (free) - installed in step 3.
- This project folder (from GitHub, branch `claude/vmix-title-date-draw-id-omxzaj`).
- One vMix preset (.vmix file) per game and time period - 13 in total.

Game	Also called	Preset files (one per draw)
Pick 3	Daily 3, Daily Pick 3	Morning, Midday, Afternoon, Night
Play Way		Morning, Midday, Afternoon, Night
Cash 4	Daily Cash 4	Morning, Midday, Afternoon, Night
Lotto		Lotto

A preset file can use any of the game's names, e.g. *Daily 3 Night.vmix*, *Pick 3 Night.vmix* or *Daily Pick 3 Night.vmix* are all recognised as Pick 3 Night (section 9).

3. Install Python

1. On the vMix PC open **https://www.python.org/downloads/** and click **Download Python 3.x**.
2. Run the installer. On the first screen tick **"Add python.exe to PATH"** at the bottom. This is the most important step.
3. Click **Install Now** and wait for "Setup was successful". Click Close.
4. Check it: press the Windows key, type **cmd**, press Enter, then type `py --version` and press Enter. You should see something like `Python 3.12.4`.

> **Important:** If the check shows "not recognized", run the installer again, choose **Modify**, and make sure "Add Python to environment variables" is ticked.

4. Copy the files to the vMix PC

1. Open the GitHub repository **damionejdarbeau/vmixdatainput**.
2. Use the branch selector (top left of the file list) to choose `claude/vmix-title-date-draw-id-omxzaj`. The .bat files are on this branch.
3. Click the green **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**.
4. Right-click the ZIP and choose **Extract All...**
5. Move the extracted folder to `C:\vMixLotto` (any folder works, but this guide uses that one).

The folder should now contain these files:

```
C:\vMixLotto\
    vmix_lotto_data.py        the program
    config.json               settings (Supabase, website, games)
    supabase_key.txt          your Supabase key (you create it, step 6a)
    overrides.example.json    example for manual draw numbers
    run_once.bat              update once (for testing)
    run_loop.bat              keep updating every 5 minutes
    check_sources.bat         show what Supabase and the website contain
    fix_today.bat             record draws moved or cancelled today
    supabase\vmix_read_access.sql   only if the key cannot read results
    install_autostart.bat     start automatically at log on
    remove_autostart.bat      undo the automatic start
    vmix_scripts\SetDateText.vb
    docs\vMix_Lotto_Setup_Guide.pdf   (this guide)
```

> **Important:** If Windows shows the .bat files as plain "Windows Batch File" but they do nothing, right-click one > **Properties** and tick **Unblock** at the bottom (files downloaded from the internet are sometimes blocked).

5. First test run

1. Double-click **run_once.bat** in C:\vMixLotto.
2. A black window opens and prints one line per game, for example:

```
[2026-10-03 09:15:02] Date text: Sat. 3rd Oct. 2026
[2026-10-03 09:15:03]   pick3_morning          next draw 10452    (supabase)
[2026-10-03 09:15:03]   pick3_midday           next draw 10453    (supabase)
...
[2026-10-03 09:15:04]   lotto                  next draw 2101     (web)
[2026-10-03 09:15:04] vMix: pushed playway_night into 'LottoTitle' (preset ...)
```

1. A new folder **C:\vMixLotto\output** now holds 13 game files plus **all_games.csv**. Open all_games.csv in Excel or Notepad to check every value at once. Press any key to close the window.

The word in brackets shows where each number came from: **supabase**, **web**, **override**, **cached** (last good value) or **none** (nothing found yet - DRAW_ID will be blank). Before you finish section 6, "none" and Supabase/website error lines are normal.

6. Tell the script where to find draw numbers

All settings are in **config.json**. Open it with Notepad (right-click > Open with > Notepad). Keep the quotes and commas exactly as they are; a missing comma stops the program from starting.

6a. Supabase - the email blast results (main source)

config.json is already set up for your results database: **daily_results** for the daily games and **lotto_results** for Lotto. You only need to give it the project address and a key.

Step 1 - copy the project address and key.

1. Log in at **https://supabase.com/dashboard** and open the project that holds the results.
2. Click **Project Settings** (the cog, bottom left), then **API** (in newer dashboards: **Data API** for the URL and **API Keys** for the key).
3. Copy the **Project URL** (looks like `https://abcdefghijkl.supabase.co`). In config.json replace `https://YOUR-PROJECT-ID.supabase.co` with it.
4. Copy the **anon / public** key (newer dashboards call it the **publishable** key).
5. In C:\vMixLotto create a new text file called **supabase_key.txt**, paste the key into it (nothing else) and save.

> **Important:** Use the **anon / publishable** key, not the **service_role / secret** key. The secret key can change or delete everything in the database (staff, recipients, blasts) and must not be stored on the vMix PC. Keep supabase_key.txt out of emails and GitHub.

> **Tip:** In File Explorer turn on **View > File name extensions** so Notepad does not save the file as supabase_key.txt.txt.

Step 2 - check it. Double-click **check_sources.bat**. Under SUPABASE it shows the latest rows of daily_results and lotto_results, then the draw ID every preset would get right now:

```
SUPABASE
Project: https://abcdefghijkl.supabase.co
Columns in 'daily_results': id, draw_date, period, play_way_draw_no, ...
Latest rows:
  {"draw_date": "2026-10-03", "period": "mid_morning", "play_way_draw_no": 505, ...
  ...
Draw IDs the feeder would use right now:
  pick3_morning          705
  pick3_midday           706
  ...
  playway_night          508
  lotto                  2101
```

Compare a few of these with your own records. If they are right, the Supabase part is done.

Important: If it says a table **returned no rows** but the table has data, the public key is not allowed to read it. Open **supabase\vmix_read_access.sql** from the folder, paste it into the Supabase **SQL Editor** and click Run. It allows reading **published** results only - results waiting for approval stay hidden, and nothing can be changed with the key.

How the draw ID is worked out

vMix preset	Supabase column	Period
Pick 3 / Daily 3 / Daily Pick 3 ...	daily_results.pick3_draw_no	
Play Way ...	daily_results.play_way_draw_no	
Cash 4 / Daily Cash 4 ...	daily_results.cash4_draw_no	
... Morning		mid_morning
... Midday		midday
... Afternoon		mid_afternoon
... Night		evening
Lotto	lotto_results.draw_no	(one draw per date)

Draw numbers run in one sequence through the day (mid-morning, midday, mid-afternoon, evening, then the next day). So for each preset the program:

1. uses **today's row for that period** if it already has a draw number;
2. otherwise takes the **latest draw number** in the table and counts forward one per draw slot to today's period. Example: yesterday's evening Play Way was 504, so today is mid-morning 505, midday 506, mid-afternoon 507, evening 508.

Lotto works the same way with one draw per date: the latest draw_no plus 1, or today's row if it is already there.

Tip: On a disrupted or cancelled day the count can be off. Use a manual override (6c) for that day.

Lotto jackpot

For Lotto the program also reads **lotto_results.jackpot_amount** into a **JACKPOT** value, shown as e.g. **$1,250,000**. If today's Lotto row has a jackpot, that is used; otherwise the jackpot of the latest draw. That can be too low after a roll-over, so enter today's Lotto row (with its jackpot) before the show, or use an override (6c):

```
{ "lotto": { "date": "2026-10-03", "jackpot": 1500000 } }
```

6b. The website (backup source)

The website address is near the top of config.json:

```
"website_url": "https://about.nla.gd/",
```

When the address changes in future, change only this line and save.

Each game has a **label_regex** - the game name as it appears on the website. The program finds that name and reads the first *Draw ... number* that follows it. The WEBSITE part of **check_sources.bat** lists every draw number found on the page with the text around it (also saved to **check_result.txt**).

- If the page says `PLAY WAY - NIGHT ... Draw No: 3512`, the default `Play\\s*Way\\W{0,20}Night` already matches it.
- If the page uses another word for the number, e.g. *Game #3512*, add a draw_regex line to that game's web source:

```
{ "type": "web",
  "label_regex": "Play\\s*Way\\W{0,20}Night",
  "draw_regex": "Game\\s*#\\s*(\\d+)",
  "window": 400 }
```

> **Tip:** To make the website the **main** source instead of Supabase, move its block above the supabase block inside that game's "sources" list.

6c. Manual override (when you need to type a number in)

1. Copy **overrides.example.json** and rename the copy to **overrides.json**.
2. Edit it so it lists only the games you want to force, with today's date and the draw ID to show:

```
{
  "playway_night": { "date": "2026-10-03", "next_draw": 3513 }
}
```

The override only applies on that date, so a forgotten override cannot show a wrong number tomorrow. An entry can also hold a Lotto **jackpot** (6a), with or without next_draw. The game names (keys) are listed in the Appendix.

7. Prepare the title in vMix

Your title already has the two fields **Date.Text** and **DRAW_ID.Text**; the program is set up for exactly these names.

1. In vMix open the title input's **Title Editor** and confirm the field list shows **Date.Text** and **DRAW_ID.Text**.
2. Right-click the title input > **Input Settings** > General, and set its name (title) to **LottoTitle**. Use this same name in every preset.
3. Save the preset.

The **Lotto** title also needs a text field for the jackpot named **JACKPOT** (vMix lists it as **JACKPOT.Text**). If yours has another name, change "vmix_field" under the lotto game's "extras" in config.json.

> **Important:** Field names must match exactly, including capitals and the underscore: **DRAW_ID.Text**, not Draw_ID.Text or DRAW ID.Text. If a title uses different names, change "date_field" and "draw_field" in the "vmix_api" part of config.json.

8. Connect each preset to its data file

Repeat these steps in each of the 13 presets. Run **run_once.bat** first so the files exist.

1. Open the preset, e.g. **Pick 3 Morning.vmix**.
2. Open the **Data Sources Manager**. Depending on your vMix version this is the **Data Sources** button at the bottom of the main window, or under **Settings**.
3. Click **Add**, choose **Excel/CSV**, and browse to the file for this preset (table below), e.g. `C:\vMixLotto\output\pick3_morning.csv`. Click OK.
4. In the Data Sources Manager, turn on **Auto Refresh** and set it to **10** seconds. Make sure the first row is used as the header (column names **Date** and **DRAW_ID** should appear).
5. Open the title's **Title Editor** (click the cog on the title input, or right-click > Title Editor) and click **Data Source**.
6. For **Date.Text** choose this data source and column **Date**. For **DRAW_ID.Text** choose column **DRAW_ID**. In the Lotto preset also bind **JACKPOT.Text** to column **JACKPOT**. Close the window.
7. Check the preview: the date and draw ID should appear in the title.
8. **Save the preset** (File/Save). The link is stored inside the .vmix file, so you never have to do this again for that preset.

> **Important:** Each preset must point at **its own** file. A Night preset pointing at the Morning file will show the Morning draw ID.

Preset	Data file in C:\vMixLotto\output
Pick 3 Morning	pick3_morning.csv
Pick 3 Midday	pick3_midday.csv
Pick 3 Afternoon	pick3_afternoon.csv
Pick 3 Night	pick3_night.csv
Play Way Morning	playway_morning.csv
Play Way Midday	playway_midday.csv
Play Way Afternoon	playway_afternoon.csv
Play Way Night	playway_night.csv
Cash 4 Morning	cash4_morning.csv
Cash 4 Midday	cash4_midday.csv
Cash 4 Afternoon	cash4_afternoon.csv
Cash 4 Night	cash4_night.csv
Lotto	lotto.csv

Each file has a header row and one data row, for example:

```
"Game","Date","DRAW_ID"
"Play Way Night","Sat. 3rd Oct. 2026","  Draw ID:  3513"
```

9. Optional: direct push through the vMix Web API

This sends the values straight into the open preset's title, as well as writing the files. Use it if you prefer not to set up Data Sources, or as a second safety net. Both can be used together.

1. In vMix open **Settings > Web Controller**, tick **Enable**, keep port **8088**, and click OK.
2. In config.json check that `"vmix_api"` has `"enabled": true` and `"title_input": "LottoTitle"`.
3. Each game has a **preset_match** list of the names its preset file may have. Pick 3 Night, for example, accepts *Daily Pick 3 Night*, *Pick 3 Night* and *Daily 3 Night*; Cash 4 Night accepts *Daily Cash 4 Night* and *Cash 4 Night*. Upper/lower case, spaces and dashes are ignored. If a file has another name (e.g. *Dail3 Morning.vmix*), add it to that game's list: `"preset_match": ["Daily Pick 3 Morning", "Pick 3 Morning", "Daily 3 Morning", "Dail3 Morning"]`.
4. Open a preset, run **run_once.bat**, and look for the line `vMix: pushed ... into 'LottoTitle'`.

Important: The program picks the first game whose preset_match is found in the file name. Keep the names specific, e.g. "Pick 3 Night" and "Cash 4 Night", not just "Night".

Tip: The output files (section 8) keep one name per game - pick3_..., playway_..., cash4_... - whatever the preset file is called.

10. Start automatically with Windows

1. Right-click **install_autostart.bat** and choose **Run as administrator**. Click Yes.
2. You should see "Done. The feeder will start each time you log on."
3. To start it now without logging off, double-click **run_loop.bat**.

A window titled **vMix Lotto Data Feeder** stays open and prints an update every 5 minutes. Minimise it, but do not close it. If the program stops for any reason, the window restarts it after 30 seconds.

To stop the automatic start, right-click **remove_autostart.bat** > Run as administrator.

Tip: To update more or less often, edit run_loop.bat and change `--loop 300` (seconds).

11. Name and file the recordings

vMix cannot name a recording after the draw, so the program does it. vMix records into a holding folder; as soon as you stop recording, the program moves the file and renames it:

```
C:\Users\user\Documents\vmixstorage\2026-10-03\Pick_3\Pick_3_7930_Night_2026-10-03.mp4
C:\Users\user\Documents\vmixstorage\2026-10-03\Cash_4\Cash_4_8120_Morning_2026-10-03.mp4
C:\Users\user\Documents\vmixstorage\2026-10-03\Lotto\Lotto_2101_2026-10-03.mp4
```

The game and period come from the preset that was loaded when recording **started**, and the draw number is the one shown in the title. Loading the next preset straight after stopping is fine.

Set up vMix (once):

1. In File Explorer create the folder `C:\Users\user\Documents\vmixstorage\_incoming`.
2. In vMix open **Settings > Recording**. Set the **folder** to `C:\Users\user\Documents\vmixstorage\_incoming` and choose an **MP4** format. Click OK.
3. Check that **Settings > Web Controller** is enabled (section 9). The program uses it to see which preset is loaded and when recording starts and stops.
4. Keep **run_loop.bat** running (section 10). It checks vMix every 5 seconds.
5. Record as usual with the vMix **Record** button. A few seconds after you stop, the window shows `Recording saved: C:\Users\user\Documents\vmixstorage\...`

> **Important:** If the Windows user name is not **user**, change the two paths starting `C:\\Users\\user` in the `"recordings"` part of config.json (note the double back-slashes) and the vMix recording folder.

- A second recording of the same draw is saved with **_2**, **_3** ... added; nothing is ever overwritten.
- If the preset matches no game, the file stays in _incoming and the window says so. Rename it by hand or add the preset name to that game's preset_match list (section 9).
- If the draw number was unknown, the name contains **NoDraw**.
- To turn this off, set `"enabled": false` under `"recordings"`.

12. When a draw is moved or cancelled

If a draw cannot be held on time, tell the program, so that the titles and recording names stay right. Example from 9 Nov 2026: the Morning draw was moved to Midday, and then to the Afternoon slot (4:45).

1. Double-click **fix_today.bat** (or answer **Y** when run_loop.bat or run_once.bat asks *Any draw changes today?* at start-up; with no answer they carry on after 15 seconds).
2. Choose **1 A draw is being held in a different time slot**.
3. Choose the games: press Enter for **all daily games** (Pick 3, Play Way, Cash 4), or pick one game.
4. Choose the draw that moved (**Morning**), then the slot it is held in now (**Midday**). If it moves again, repeat with the new slot (**Afternoon**); the new answer replaces the old one.
5. Check the table it shows, then choose **Done**. The running feeder picks the change up within a few seconds.
6. At air time, load the preset for the slot you are airing in (here the **Afternoon** preset). Its title shows the moved draw's number and the recording is saved under that slot.

```
Draw IDs now:        Morning   Midday    Afternoon Night
  Pick 3             13273     13274     13273     13276
  Play Way           10845     10846     10845     10848
  Cash 4             8042      8043      8042      8045
recording: Pick_3_13273_Afternoon_2026-11-09.mp4
```

- **2 A draw is cancelled (its number is not used)**: later draws that day move down one number, and the cancelled slot's title stays blank.
- **3 Remove** or **4 Clear all** undo mistakes. Changes only last for today; tomorrow starts as a normal day by itself.
- If the database cannot be read while changes are active, the draw ID is left **blank** rather than showing an old number. Use an override (6c).

13. Daily checklist

- The **vMix Lotto Data Feeder** window is open on the vMix PC.
- Its latest lines show a draw number and **(supabase)** or **(web)** for each game - not **(none)** or **(cached)** for hours.
- The PC clock and date are correct (the date text comes from it).
- Before going on air, check the title preview: correct date and a draw ID one higher than the last published result.
- If a draw is moved or cancelled, run **fix_today.bat** (section 12).
- If a number is still wrong, use an override (6c) and wait up to 5 minutes, or run run_once.bat to update immediately.

14. Changing things later

To change...	Edit	Example
Website address	config.json: website_url	"https://results.nla.gd/"
Month spelling	config.json: month_names	"Sep." instead of "Sept."
Day spelling	config.json: day_names	"Mon" without the dot
Date layout	config.json: pattern	"{day} {date} {month}, {year}" gives Mon. 9th Sept., 2026
Jackpot look	config.json: lotto > extras > format	"EC${0:,.0f}" or "${0:,.2f}" (cents)
Draw ID text	config.json: draw_format (now " Draw ID: {0}")	"Draw #{0}", or "{0:06d}" for leading zeros
Recording folder / name	config.json: recordings > folder, filename	"{game}-{period}-{draw}{ext}"
Add / rename a game	config.json: copy a game block, change the key, name, preset_match and sources	Run run_once.bat to create its file
Update interval	run_loop.bat: --loop 300	--loop 120 = 2 minutes

The running program reloads config.json automatically on its next update, so there is no need to restart it after saving.

15. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
"Python was not found"	Repeat step 3 and tick "Add python.exe to PATH".
Window opens and closes at once	Run run_once.bat - it stays open and shows the error.
"Config file not found" or a JSON error	A quote or comma is missing in config.json. Open it at jsonlint.com to find the line.
DRAW_ID is blank, source (none)	No source returned a number. Run check_sources.bat (6a). Use an override (6c) meanwhile.
"Supabase url/key not set"	Put the Project URL in config.json and the key in supabase_key.txt (6a).
"Supabase HTTP 401" / Invalid API key	The key in supabase_key.txt is wrong or has extra text. Copy it again.
"Supabase HTTP 404" / relation does not exist	A table was renamed in the database. Update "table" in config.json.
"Supabase HTTP 400" / column does not exist	A column was renamed. Update "draw_column" in config.json.
Supabase table returns no rows	Run supabase\vmix_read_access.sql in the SQL Editor (6a).
Draw ID is one or more off	A draw was skipped, cancelled or entered late. Use an override (6c).
"web source failed: urlopen error"	The website cannot be reached. Check internet access or the address in website_url. Supabase is still used first.
"... lower than previous ... ignored"	A source returned an older number. Normally harmless; check the source if it keeps happening.
Title does not change in vMix	Check Auto Refresh is on and the field is bound to the right column (section 8). Open the CSV in Notepad to confirm it has the value.
"vMix: could not set 'Date.Text'..."	The title input is not named LottoTitle or the field name differs (section 7). The CSV files are still updated.
Recording stays in _incoming	The loaded preset matches no game (add its name to preset_match), or run_loop.bat is not running.
"vMix API not reachable"	Only matters for section 9. Enable Settings > Web Controller.
"no game matches loaded preset"	Fix preset_match so it is part of the preset's file name (section 9).
Wrong date	Fix the Windows clock/time zone on the vMix PC.

Appendix: game keys

These names are used for the output files, overrides.json and config.json.

Key	Recognised preset names	Supabase column	period
pick3_morning	Pick 3 / Daily 3 / Daily Pick 3 Morning	pick3_draw_no	mid_morning
pick3_midday	Pick 3 / Daily 3 / Daily Pick 3 Midday	pick3_draw_no	midday
pick3_afternoon	Pick 3 / Daily 3 / Daily Pick 3 Afternoon	pick3_draw_no	mid_afternoon
pick3_night	Pick 3 / Daily 3 / Daily Pick 3 Night	pick3_draw_no	evening
playway_morning	Play Way Morning	play_way_draw_no	mid_morning
playway_midday	Play Way Midday	play_way_draw_no	midday
playway_afternoon	Play Way Afternoon	play_way_draw_no	mid_afternoon
playway_night	Play Way Night	play_way_draw_no	evening
cash4_morning	Cash 4 / Daily Cash 4 Morning	cash4_draw_no	mid_morning
cash4_midday	Cash 4 / Daily Cash 4 Midday	cash4_draw_no	midday
cash4_afternoon	Cash 4 / Daily Cash 4 Afternoon	cash4_draw_no	mid_afternoon
cash4_night	Cash 4 / Daily Cash 4 Night	cash4_draw_no	evening
lotto	Lotto	lotto_results.draw_no	-

Date-only fallback without Python

vmix_scripts\SetDateText.vb sets only the date field from inside vMix (no draw ID). In vMix 4K/Pro: Settings > Scripting > Add, paste the file's contents, name it SetDateText, and start it from a shortcut or trigger. Use it only if the Python feeder cannot run.